



Dialogues 1

Beginning a call

- A:** I'd like to speak to Max Reed, please.
B: Just one moment. I'll connect you ... You're through now.
C: Max Reed speaking.
A: Hi, Max. Simon here.
C: Hi, Simon. How are you?
A: Fine. And you?

Checking information

- A:** Hello.
B: Hello, John. Sven here. Did you get my email?
A: Yes, it's right here in front of me.
B: Fine. I thought it would be quicker to phone than send you another message.
A: I wanted to run through some of the arrangements for Tuesday...

Asking the caller to hold

- A:** Sorry to keep you waiting so long. Could you hold on a little longer? The network is very slow today.
B: How long do you think it is going to take to find the information?
A: It won't be long now. Right. Here we are. The figures you need are ...

Asking the caller to leave a message

- A:** I'm trying to get hold of someone in your sales department. Are you having problems with your phone system? I was cut off earlier and now there is no reply.
B: Just a moment, please. I'll try the number for you. Yes, I'm afraid there's no reply from the department. They must be at lunch. Would you like to leave a message and I'll get someone to call you when they get back.
A: Thanks. My name's Baz Mehot and the number is 453980.

Making sure you understand

- A:** Can I speak to Teresa Riller? I understand that she is looking after Sales while Marco Stam is on parental leave.
B: That's right, but I'm afraid she's not here at the moment. Can I take a message?
A: Thanks. Could you say that Pieter Baumgartner called and ask her to call me back?
B: Can you spell your name, please?
A: Baumgartner is B-a-u-m-g-a-r-t-n-e-r. I'm at the Rainbow Hotel in room 13.
B: Is that 13, one three, or 30, three zero?
A: Thirteen, one three.
B: Thanks. I'll pass on the message.

Ending a call

- A:** ... OK. Have we covered everything?
B: I think so. You just need to let me know when you can send the report.
A: That's right. I'll send you a message when I get back to the office. Anyway, thanks for calling.
B: No problem. I'll wait to hear from you.

Notes

I'd like to speak to Max Reed, please.

Some other phrases for checking if someone is available:

Is Max Reed there?

Can I talk to Max Reed?

Is Max Reed available?

Hi, Max. Simon here.

This is an informal greeting. More formal greetings include:

Hello, Mr Reed. This is Simon Speedwell speaking.

Mr Reed. Hello, it's Simon Speedwell here.

I wanted to run through ...

We often introduce the topic politely by using the past tense. We can also use *I'd like to...*

For example:

I wanted to run through the arrangements.

I wanted to ask you a question.

I wanted to know about your travel plans.

I'd like to ask you a question.

Sorry to keep you waiting ...

Some other phrases to use when someone is waiting on the phone:

Could you hold on?

Do you mind holding.

Would you like to leave a message?

Would is used to introduce a polite offer.

Note also:

Would you like me to check?

Would you like to call back later?

Would you like to hold on?

... I'll get someone to call you when they get back.

Note the use of the simple present tense *when they get ...* in this sentence:

I'll call you if I can.

I'll phone you when they arrive.

I'll let you know if I hear anything.

I'll fax you if I remember the name.

I understand that she is looking after Sales ...

Language that indicates that you already have some information:

I understand that you're coming to Warsaw next week.

I hear that Pedro is moving to Singapore.

I see (that) they're going to open a new office in Paris.

... Marco Stam is on parental leave.

Some other reasons for absence include:

He's on paternity leave.

She's on maternity leave.

She's taking compassionate leave.

He's ill.

She's on holiday.

He's left for the day.

... I'm afraid she's not here at the moment.

Use *I'm afraid* or *I'm Sorry* to when passing on unwelcome information.

I'm afraid I can't help you.

I'm sorry I'm going to be late.

I'm afraid I can't find the information you need.

Have we covered everything?

Note how we signal that a call is coming to an end:

So is that everything?

Is that all?

Anyway, thanks for calling.

Other ways of bringing a call to an end:

Right, I'll check the details and call you back.

I think that's everything.

Is there anything else?

British/American differences

Some differences between British and American English:

British

parental leave

compassionate leave

She's on holiday.

American

family leave

In American English the term *bereavement leave* is also used.

She's on vacation.



Dialogues 2

A voicemail message

This is Ann Forsell's voicemail. I'm sorry I can't take your call at the moment, but please leave a message and I'll get back to you. Alternatively you can leave a message with my assistant. His number is 0046, (that's the country code for Sweden), 01, (that's the area code), 2132. Many thanks.'

Leaving a message

'Hi, Fiona. I've been trying to get hold of you all morning so I hope you get this. Please call Sara Remondi as soon as you can. **It's about the meeting next month.** Unfortunately **I can't make it** so we need to talk urgently. It's two o'clock my time by the way and I'll be going home in three hours. Bye for now.'

You can't talk

- A: Hello.
- B: Hi, John. **Can you talk?**
- A: Not really. **I'm in a meeting.** Can I call you back in, say, fifteen minutes?
- B: Sure. Speak to you later. It isn't urgent.

The reason for calling

- A: Can you hear me now? I couldn't hear you very well earlier. The reception was terrible. Anyway, how are you?
- B: Fine. **I was just ringing to check the time** for next week's meeting. Is it still three o'clock?

You can't hear the caller

- A: Hello.
- B: Hello. **Sorry, I can't hear you very well.** I'm in a restaurant and they have just started playing some loud music.
- A: I didn't catch that.
- B: **I'll just go outside.** Just a moment. Can you hear me now?
- A: Yes, that's much better. I'm glad you're enjoying yourself.

You have to end the call

- A: John, Peter has just arrived. I'll call you when I get back to London.
- B: Fine. I'll be here until 5. Speak to you later. Bye.
- A: Bye.

An automated message

'Welcome to Haznor Business Systems. This is a toll-free number. Please choose one of the following four options. **If you are calling about an existing order, please press 1.** If you wish to place a new order, press 2...'

Notes

This is Ann Forsell's voicemail.

Some other formal opening phrases for voicemail are:

You're through to Ann Forsell's voicemail.

You've reached Ann's voicemail.

An informal opening:

Hi. Ann here. Sorry I can't take your call at the moment but leave a message and I'll get back to you.

It's about the meeting next month.

Calls often begin with:

I'm calling/ringing about (your flight).

John, about (your flight to Paris).

... I can't make it ...

Make is often used instead of *attend* in informal usage:

Unfortunately, I can't make the next meeting.

I can't make Friday but Thursday would be fine.

Will you be able to make it?

Can you talk?

Other useful phrases for checking if the person you want to talk to is free, and some replies:

Are you busy?

Are you free to talk?

Have you got two minutes?

Can I call you back?

It's difficult at the moment.

This is a good time to talk.

I'm in a meeting.

Some other reasons why you cannot take a call:

I'm not at my desk.

I'm driving. (I'll just pull over.)

I'm just getting on a train.

I've just arrived at the airport.

I haven't got my diary with me.

I was just ringing to check the time ...

I was just ringing/calling ... is a useful alternative way to start a call:

I was just calling about the meeting next Friday.

I was just ringing to see if everything's OK for tomorrow.

I was just calling to ask for some advice.

Sorry, I can't hear you very well.

Some other phrases to use when reception is bad:

Sorry, could you repeat that?

Could you say that again?

I'm sorry, I didn't catch that.

I'm afraid the line's bad. Did you say fifteen?

Could you speak louder? The line's very bad.

I'll just go outside.

Use will when you offer or promise to do something.

I'll call you when I get back to London.

I'll be here until 5.

I'll tell her you called.

I'll make sure she gets the message.

I'll get back to you as soon as I can.

If you are calling about an existing order, please press 1.

Some other 'automated' instructions:

Press the star key twice.

Press the hash/square key.

Press 5 to speak to the operator.

Please replace the handset.

British/American differences

British

American

Differences in expressing time:

Monday to Friday

Monday through Friday

ten past six

ten after six

the ninth of December

December ninth

24-hour clock:

12-hour clock:

9:00, 17:00

9 a.m., 5 p.m.

Note: In the UK both 12-hour and 24-hour clocks are used but in the US the 24-hour clock is generally used only by the military.

Some differences in saying telephone numbers:

360-4458 = three six oh, double-four five eight

360-4458 = three six zero, forty-four fifty-eight

Other differences

Mobile phone (p12)

cell(ular) phone

directory enquiries

directory assistance/

(p13)

information

dialled (p14)

dialed

Practice

- 1 Complete the sentences using the verbs from the box below. Use each verb once only.**

press try call hear leave keep want ~~say~~ hold hang get

EXAMPLE: I'm trying to ... **get** ... hold of Peter Ince.

- a Would you like to ... **leave** ... a message?
- b I can't ... **hear** ... you very well. Please speak up.
- c Could you ... **hold** ... on, please? I won't be long.
- d Sorry to ... **keep** ... you waiting.
- e Can I ... **call** ... you later?
- f If you ... **want** ... to place an order, ... **press** ... the star key.
- g I'll ... **get** ... someone to call you later.
- h He didn't ... **say** ... when he would be back in the office.
- i Please don't ... **hang** ... up. I'll ... **try** ... the number again.

- 2 Write what you would say in these situations. Refer to the dialogues and notes.**

EXAMPLE: You are the manager. The phone rings and you pick it up. The caller asks 'Is that the manager?' What do you say?

Yes, [Tina Forget] speaking.

- a Your female colleague is off work as she has just had a baby. What do you say to the caller who wants to speak to her?
she's on maternity leave at the moment
- b You are in a meeting and you receive a call on your mobile phone. You cannot speak. What do you say?
I am afraid I'm in a meeting. Can I call you back?
- c Leave a message on your colleague Peter's voicemail. Say that you called and ask him to call back when he gets the message.
Hello Peter, it's Fiona. Please call me back as soon as you can
- d You don't catch the caller's name. Ask him to spell it.
Please can you spell your name
- e A colleague phones to let you know her hotel room number but you can't hear her very well. You are not sure whether it is fifteen or fifty. What do you say?
I am sorry I didn't catch the number. Did you say fifteen or fifty?

3 Complete the sentences with a preposition.

EXAMPLE: I'll call you **in** ten minutes.

- a I'm trying to connect you. Could you hold **on**?
- b When are you going **on** holiday?
- c I'm calling **about** the order I placed last week.
- d Could you pass **on** a message for me?
- e I'll write to you **in** two weeks' time.
- f Tom is **on** paternity leave.

4 Choose an appropriate response.

- | | |
|--------------------------------------|---|
| 1 What's the time in New York? | a Sure, what's your number? |
| 2 When will Eleanor be back? | b Speaking. |
| 3 Is that Tariq Meltam? | c Yes, of course. Let me just find a pen. |
| 4 Is Mr Rotund there? | d Nine a.m. |
| 5 Have a good weekend. | e Yes, it's right here. |
| 6 Did you get my email? | f Yes, it's 09. |
| 7 Could you call me back? | g Yes, he has just come into the office. |
| 8 Can you take a message for me? | h In ten days' time. |
| 9 Do you know the code for Helsinki? | i Thanks. You too. |

5 Complete the sentences with **will** or the present simple tense.

EXAMPLE: I (give) him the message when I (see) him.

- a I (tell) him you called.
I'll give him the message when I see him.
- b If I (find) the information, I (let) you know immediately.
I will tell
- c If Peter (not come back) from sick leave soon, we (need) to find a replacement.
if I find
- d If you (push) that button, you (disconnect) the caller.
doesn't come back **will need**
- e What (do) if you (not find) Sergei's number?
push **will disconnect**
- f If I (not find) his number, I (call) directory enquiries.
will you do **if you don't find**
don't find **will call**

6 Complete the sentences with one of the alternatives.

EXAMPLE: Press the **hash** key.

hash/button/door

a Replace the **handset**.

reception/handset/operator

b Make a **toll-free** call.

toll-free/star/line

c **This is** Anne's voice mail.

Here is/This is/Hello to

d I couldn't **get** hold of John.

get/take/make

e Please don't **hang** up.

hang/hold/take

f Don't forget to **turn off** your mobile phone.

turn off/close/drop

g Did you dial the **area** code first?

area/secret/town

7 Put the dialogue in the right order

- Speaking.
- Hi Tarmo.
- Thanks, Tarmo
- I'll do it now.
- Of course,
- Did you get my message?
- You'd like me to send directions to the office.
- Can I speak to Tarmo Star please?
- Yes that's right.
- Could you send them today?
- Yes I did.
- See you soon.

H a **b/f/ K/ G/ I/J/ E/ D/ C/ L**

8 Match the two parts of the sentences.

- Press the star key
- Could you leave a message
- I'll call you **H**
- Please wait. I'll just put you
- I'm sorry, I must have dialled
- We need to set up **B**
- I need to check the number **F**
- I'm sorry but I can't **C**

- on hold for a minute.
- a conference call for next week.
- take the call at the moment.
- the wrong number.
- to return to the main menu.
- with directory enquiries.
- for me on my voicemail?
- when I get back to my office.

2

A company visit

**Some useful phrases.**

Listen to the recording and repeat.

Could you give me directions to your office?

Just follow the signs.

Go past the station and take the first turning on the left.

You'll see the office on the right-hand side.

I've left my car in a reserved space

I have an appointment with Hans Ekburg.

Take the lift to the fourth floor.

His office is the fifth on the right, along the corridor.

Hello Hans, I'd like you to meet our Marketing Manager.

Pleased to meet you.

Tell me something about the company.

What does the company do?

We're in the transport business.

We employ just under 5 000 people worldwide.

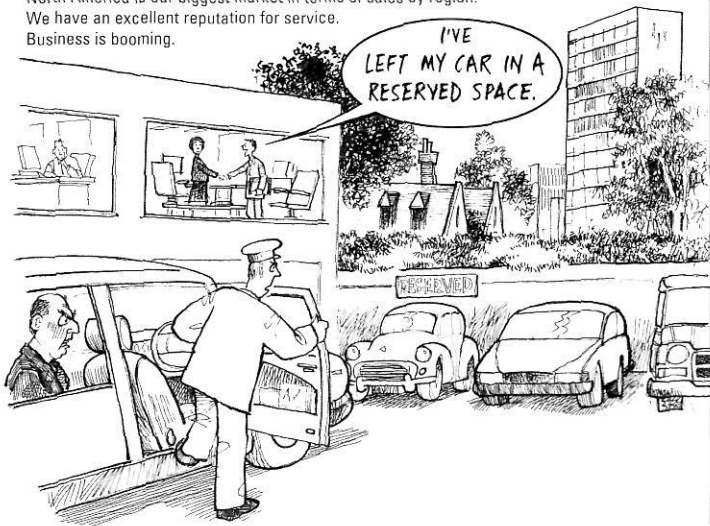
The company was set up five years ago.

We're the largest manufacturer in the country.

North America is our biggest market in terms of sales by region.

We have an excellent reputation for service.

Business is booming.





Dialogues 1

Directions to the office

- A: Hi, Rosa. It's June here. I'm in the town centre outside the bus station. **Could you tell me how to get to your office from here?**
- B: Sure. Follow the signs for Frankfurt. **After about two kilometres, you'll see a garage on your right.** Carry on for another 200 metres and then turn left. Our office is on the left-hand side, just before a railway bridge. When you arrive, **park in one of the visitors' spaces** just outside the main building.
- A: Thanks, Rosa. See you soon.

Getting lost

- A: Hi, Carla.
- B: Hello, Bob. Is everything all right?
- A: Not really. I'm lost. **I'm calling from a service station** on the E7 just south of a place called Melton. I don't have a map with me so could you direct me to the factory.
- B: Sure. **Take the first left after the service station** and follow the road to Porlock. Pass the shopping centre on your right and then take the first left. **Carry on for three kilometres** and you'll see the factory.
- A: Thanks.

Arrival

- A: Good morning, can I help you?
- B: Yes, **I have an appointment with Hans Ekburg.** Could you tell him I'm here? I've left my car in a reserved space.
- A: That's OK, I'll take the car registration number. Could you write your name here please and wear this? *[hands over a visitor's badge]*. **Do you know the building?**
- B: I'm afraid I don't.
- A: OK, go up these stairs and take the lift to the third floor. **Mr Ekburg's office is the fifth on the right, along the corridor.**
- B: Thanks.

Meeting

- A: **Hello, John. Good to see you again.**
- B: And you.
- A: John, **I'd like you to meet Lera Berman,** our Marketing Manager.
- B: Hello, John. Pleased to meet you. **Did you have a good journey?**
- B: Yes, very good. The directions were very clear.

Notes

Could you tell me how to get to the office from here?

We also say:

Can you tell me the way to ...?

How do I get to ...?

Excuse me, where is the main office?

After about two kilometres you'll see a garage on your right.

Some other landmarks:

You'll pass some shops.

Then you'll see a large red building in front of you.

Keep going and you'll come to the entrance gate.

Park in one of the visitors' spaces ...

Parking the car:

I've left my car in a reserved space.

There are some spaces reserved for visitors.

Can I park here?

Is this space reserved?

I'm calling from a service station ...

When you need to say where you are:

I'm calling from the train.

I'm on the M1 motorway.

I'm calling from a service station on the M4.

Take the first left after the service station ...

Some useful directions when you are driving:

Carry on for three kilometres.

Take the second exit at the roundabout.

Turn left at the junction.

Go straight across the crossroads.

At the traffic lights, turn right.

Carry on for three kilometres ...

Other expressions for talking about distance:

Carry/Drive on for another ten kilometres.

... until you come to a service station.

It's two hundred metres past the service station on the right-hand side.

I have an appointment with Hans Ekborg.

Note the statements and responses:

I'm here to see Hans Ekborg.

Can I have your name, please?

Could you sign in please?

Is Hans Ekborg in/available?

Yes, he's expecting you.

Do you know the building?

Checking if a visitor knows his/her way around a building:

Have you been here before?

When were you last here?

I haven't been here before.

Mr Ekborg's office is the fifth on the right, along the corridor.

Some other office locations:

It's opposite the lift.

It's just past the coffee machine.

Go through the automatic doors.

Hello, John. Good to see you again.

An informal greeting. Other possibilities:

Hi, John. How are you?

How's life?

How's it going?

Possible responses:

Fine thanks.

I'm very well.

I'd like you to meet Lera Berman, ...

Some language of introductions:

I'd like to introduce Lera Berman.

Have you (already) met?

Yes, we met last year.

Did you have a good journey?

We can also say:

How was the journey?

How was the flight/traffic?

British/American differences

British

service station

shopping centre

car registration number

lift

shops

motorway

roundabout

crossroads

traffic lights

American

gas or filling station

(shopping) mall

license plate number

elevator

stores

freeway/expressway/

interstate

traffic circle

intersection

stop lights



Dialogues 2

Introducing a company (1)

- A:** **We're in the label business.** We produce all kinds of labels – price labels, bottle labels, even postage stamps. We have factories in France, Germany, Malaysia, China and the UK.
- B:** How many people work for the company?
- A:** **We employ just over 5 000 people worldwide.** There are around 400 employees in this factory.
- B:** Is business going well?
- A:** Yes it is, and **it's growing all the time.**

Introducing a company (2)

- A:** So, **tell me more about your mailing business.**
- B:** Sure. We provide a complete packaging and mailing service for our customers. We now have branches all over the south of the country and we have plans to open new branches in the north.
- A:** What kind of company are you?
- B:** **We're a private limited company.** We're not listed on **the Stock Exchange** ... yet.

Company history

- A:** So, **how long have you been on this site?**
- B:** We moved here five years ago. Before that, we were in a very small office building in the centre of town.
- A:** And **when was the company set up?**
- B:** Ten years ago – by Simon Donna who is still the Managing Director. He started the company with just two employees.
- A:** That's very impressive.

A tour of the office

- A:** **Let me show you round the office.** Our sales representatives work in this **open plan area.** The room in the corner is Brit Gamlin's office. She's the Senior Sales Manager here. Do you know her?
- B:** No, I don't. Has she been here long?
- A:** No, she joined the company two months ago. Come with me, **I'll introduce you to her.**
- A:** Hello, Brit. I'd like you to meet Olivier Blaireau from the Paris office.
- C:** Pleased to meet you Olivier. How are things in Paris?

Notes

We're in the label business.

Some other businesses:
the transport business/the paper business
the I.T. industry/the steel industry
the retail trade/the fashion trade

We employ just over 5 000 people worldwide.

Other ways to talk about employee numbers:
We have just under 5 000 employees.
We have 5 000 people working for us.
5 000 people work for us.

... it's growing all the time.

Describing how a business is going:
The company is doing well/badly.
Things are going well/badly.
Profits are up/down.

... tell me more about your mailing business.

Other useful opening remarks:
What does the company do?
What business are you in?
I hear you work for a mailing business.

We're a private limited company.

Compare with a *public limited company* (plc).
The public can buy shares in a public limited company but not in a private limited company.

Some other types of business:
a sole trader (where one person owns the business)
a partnership (a business owned by two or more people)
a family business

... the Stock Exchange ...

The market where stocks and shares are bought and sold.

... how long have you been on this site?

We can also talk about premises (land and buildings) and location (place):
Our current premises are very convenient.
I preferred our previous location in the centre of town.

... when was the company set up?

Other ways to talk about the start of a company:
When was it established?
When was it founded?
It was founded by General Kilbride in 1922.

Let me show you around the office.

Language for 'guiding' people round the office:
Come with me.
Come this way.
Over there you can see the Manager's office.
This is where we handle orders.

... open plan area.

An office area where staff members work in one large, often partitioned, space – not in separate offices. Also known as an *open plan office*.

... I'll introduce you to her.

We can also say:
I'd like to introduce you to Brit Gamlin.
You must meet Brit Gamlin.
Let me introduce you.

British/American differences

British	American
<i>private limited</i>	<i>company or</i>
<i>company</i>	<i>corporation</i>
<i>limited (Ltd)</i>	<i>incorporated (Inc.)</i>
<i>the retail trade</i>	<i>retail business</i>
<i>public limited</i>	<i>a publicly-traded</i>
<i>company (plc)</i>	<i>company</i>
<i>a sole trader</i>	<i>a sole proprietor</i>

Dialogues 3

Business activities (1)

- A: We're the second largest manufacturer in the country of glass for the car industry. One in three cars in this country uses our glass.
- B: How many plants do you have?
- A: We have five domestic plants but we also have factories in ten other countries. As well as supplying the car industry, we sell glass for buses, trains, ships and aircraft.

Business activities (2)

- A: Tell me more about the company.
- B: Basically we run a so-called 'shopping search' website. If you visit our site, you can find links to a wide range of products and services. You can compare prices from various shops and find the best deal.
- A: That sounds very interesting, but is it secure?
- B: Yes, in my view it's far more secure than buying over the phone.

Markets

- A: Where are your biggest markets?
- B: In terms of sales by region, Europe is by far the biggest market with 60 per cent of our total sales. North America accounts for 15 per cent, Asia-Pacific is 10 per cent – the Chinese market is particularly strong, South America is 8 per cent and the rest of the world is 7 per cent.
- A: I think you'd better write that down for me! Why are things going so well in China?
- B: The Chinese economy is booming and we have a very good sales force there.

The competition

- A: Who are your main competitors?
- B: It depends on the region. There are a lot of local producers in Europe and we cannot compete with them on price. However, our reputation for service is excellent. We are well known in the market for high quality and reliability.
- A: What about the Japanese market?
- B: We cannot compete in Japan. High transport costs make it very unprofitable to do business. Maybe things will change in the future.

Notes

We're the second largest manufacturer in the country ...

Talking about the size of the company:
We're by far the largest producers of ...
We're the third biggest in the country.
We're among the largest/smallest in the region.

As well as supplying the car industry, we sell ...

Use as well as for emphasis. We can also say:
In addition to supplying the car industry, we supply many other customers.

... we run a so-called 'shopping search' website.

The speaker could also say:
It's what we call a 'shopping search' website.
These phrases show that the words *shopping search* are known to people 'in the business' but not to others.

You can compare prices from various shops ...

We can also say:
You can make comparisons between shops.
You can compare A with B.

... in my view it's far more secure ...

If you are not so sure of your facts, you might say:
As far as I know, it's more secure.

In terms of sales by region, ...

in terms (of) is a useful phrase:
What does that mean in terms of employment?
In terms of profitability, it means that ...
Can you give us the figures in percentage terms?

North America accounts for 15 per cent, ...

This means that sales to North America represent/are fifteen per cent of sales.
Note that we say 'fifteen per cent' (NOT pro cent).

The Chinese economy is booming ...

Some terms to describe the state of a market:
Demand is strong.
Demand is very weak.
There is a steady demand in Australia.
The market for our products is growing/falling.

... we cannot compete with them on price.

Ways of talking about competition:
But we can compete with them in terms of service/speed of delivery.
Our prices are very competitive.
We've become very uncompetitive in that market.

We are well known in the market ...

Ways of describing reputation:
We have a good reputation.
We have an excellent name.
Everyone knows us.
We are well established in the market.

... transport costs make it very unprofitable ...

Talking about profit and loss:
It's a very profitable business.
We're not making much profit.
We're making a loss.
We're finally making a profit.

British/American differences

British

transport costs
We're making a loss.

American

transportation costs
We're operating at a loss./We're taking a loss.

Practice

1 Complete the sentences with a preposition.

EXAMPLE: You need to take the lift ... ~~to~~ ... the third floor.

- a Take the third turning ... **on** ... the left.
- b Park ... **in** ... one of the visitors' spaces.
- c We are ... **by** ... far the largest manufacturer.
- d One ... **in** ... three of our plants is making a loss.
- e There is no profit ... **in** ... it.
- f Tell me about your sales ... **by** ... region.
- g We are very competitive ... **in** ... terms of price.
- h Are you listed ... **on** ... the Stock Exchange?
- i What kind of business are you ... **in** ... ?

2 Complete the sentences using the words in the box below.

Use each word once only.

reputation	demand	corridor	profit	site
partnership	registration	map	lift	

EXAMPLE: Could you give me directions? I don't have a **map** ...

- a Do you need my car ... **registration** ... number?
- b How long have you had offices on this ... **site** ... ?
- c You can use the stairs, but it's quicker to take the ... **lift** ...
- d My office is along the ... **corridor** ... on the right.
- e After two years of making losses, we are now making a ... **profit** ...
- f There is a growing ... **demand** ... for our products in the Middle East.
- g My brother and I went into ... **partnership** ... three years ago.
- h We have an excellent ... **reputation** ... for quality.

3 Choose an appropriate response.

- | | | |
|--|----------|---------------------------------|
| 1 Did you have a good journey? | a | a No, it's a partnership. |
| 2 Is it a limited company? | | b Just over five years ago. |
| 3 When was the company set up? | b | c Yes, that's right. |
| 4 Have you been on this site long? | h | d Thanks, I can manage. |
| 5 I hear you're in the transport business? | c | e Yes, very good thanks. |
| 6 What kind of company is it? | g | f Yes, we met last year. |
| 7 Can I help? | d | g It's a small family business. |
| 8 Do you know Gunilla? | f | h Yes, for twenty years. |

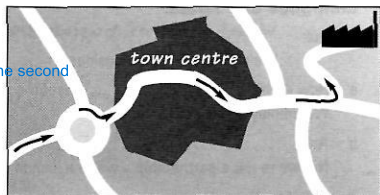
4 Write what you would say.

- a Direct someone to the factory.

At the roundabout take the second exit;

Go through the town centre and then take the second

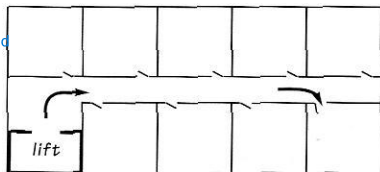
turning on the left : The factory is
at the end of the road



- b Direct someone to your office.

Take the lift to the third floor. Turn right and
along the corridor.

It's the fourth office on the right

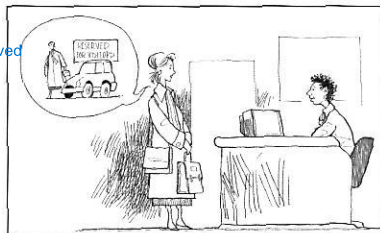


3rd floor

- c Explain where you parked your car.

I've left my car in the space "Reserved

For visitors." Is that all right?



- d Explain where you are.

I have stopped just before a bridge,

opposite a garage. I can see a signpost

It says that Fistularo is eight kilometers away



5 Write down a question for the following answers. Refer to the dialogues and notes.

EXAMPLE: What kind of business are you in?

We're in the shipping business.

- a How many people do you employ? ?
We employ just over 200 people.
- b Are you a partnership? ?
No, we're not a partnership – we're a limited company.
- c How long have you been on this site? ?
We have been on this site for three years.
- d Do you like working here? ?
Yes, I do. The working atmosphere is very good now.
- e Where is your biggest market? ?
In terms of region, the biggest market is North America.
- f Who are your biggest competitors? ?
I suppose our biggest competitors are companies in Thailand and Indonesia.
- g Can you tell me how to get to the factory? ?
Follow the road to Trieste and you'll see the factory on the right.

6 Rewrite the following in another way. Refer to the dialogues and notes.

EXAMPLE: I have an appointment with Jan Pickero.

I'm here to see Jan Pickero.

- a I've parked in a reserved space.
I've left my car in a reserved space.
- b Could you tell me the way to the main office?
could you tell me how to get to the main office?
- c I'd like to you to meet our marketing manager.
I'd like to introduce you to our Marketing Manager.
- d How was the journey?
Did you have a good journey?
- e When was the company established?
When was the company set up?
- f We are one of the largest manufacturers in the region.
We are among the largest manufactures in the region.
- g We have an excellent name in the market.

3

Job information

**Some useful phrases.**

Listen to the recording and repeat.

I work for a software company.
I'm responsible for the development of new products.
It's a very challenging job.
I report directly to the Managing Director.
The job involves a lot of travelling.
I usually start work at 8 o'clock in the morning.
Do you usually drive to work?

How's the new job?
I really enjoy it.
The salary is good.
I'm very pleased I moved here.

How has the takeover affected you?
Some people are going to lose their jobs.
Some will take early retirement.
There won't be any compulsory redundancies.

We need to recruit a new training manager.
What kind of person are you looking for?
We need someone with excellent communication skills.

I REALLY
ENJOY THIS JOB.
IT'S A GREAT COMPANY
TO WORK FOR.



Dialogues 1

Responsibilities

- A: So, what exactly do you do in the company?
B: **I'm responsible for new product development. I report directly to the CEO.**
A: **What does that involve?**
B: I supervise a team of designers. We all have to think of new ideas, test them and develop the ones that we think will succeed.
A: **It sounds challenging.**
B: It is, but I really enjoy it.

Qualifications for the job

- A: **I hear you studied in Finland.**
B: That's right. **I did a degree in Engineering** at Tampere Technical University and then I worked in a small software company in Helsinki.
A: Why did you decide to stay in Finland?
B: **I was very interested in the job.** I wanted to put my training into practice. The experience was very good and certainly helped me to get this job.

A typical day

- A: What time do you start in the mornings?
B: I aim to get to work by 8 a.m. That means leaving home at 7:30. **I usually cycle to work.**
A: **Are the hours flexible?**
B: In theory, yes, but I normally finish at 4 p.m. I sometimes finish earlier if I take a very short lunch break.
A: Do you go out for lunch?
B: Occasionally, but **I like eating in the company canteen.**

Discussing a new appointment

- A: What kind of person are we looking for?
B: We want someone who is already working as a Project Manager in a software house. He or she should have at least three years' experience.
A: What sorts of skills are needed?
B: **Excellent communication skills are essential.** The person we appoint will have a lot of direct contact with clients – we need someone who can present the company clearly.
A: **Absolutely.** So where can we find this person?
B: I think **we should advertise with an on-line recruitment agency** but we may have to use a firm of head-hunters.

Notes

I'm responsible for new product development.

We can also say:

I'm in charge of new product development.

New product development is my responsibility.

I report directly to the CEO.

This means the CEO is my boss.

CEO = Chief Executive Officer

CFO = Chief Financial Officer

MD = Managing Director

What does that involve?

Notice that we use the *-ing* form of the verb after *involve*:

It involves attending a lot of meetings.

It involves working long hours.

It sounds challenging.

challenging means demanding, tough.

The job is a challenge.

I enjoy challenges.

I hear you studied in Finland.

Note how *hear*, *understand*, and *believe* are used in conversation:

I understand you spent some time in Japan.

I believe you know Don quite well.

Possible responses:

That's right/Not really.

Yes, I was there for two years.

Yes, we're very good friends.

I did a degree in Engineering ...

Other language for describing studies:

I did a B.A. (Bachelor of Arts)

I studied for an MSc. (Master of Science)

I completed my studies last year.

I graduated from Oxford University in 1999.

I was very interested in the job.

Note the prepositions:

to be interested in, keen on, fascinated by

I usually cycle to work.

Other ways of getting to work – note the correct prepositions:

I walk/go on foot.

I drive/go by car.

I take the train/go by train.

Are the hours flexible?

Phrases to talk about flexible working:

I work flexible hours.

We have a 'flexitime' system.

... I like eating in the company canteen.

Another person may prefer to have a *takeaway* or to eat:

in a local restaurant.

at his/her desk.

in a sandwich bar.

from a market stall.

Excellent communication skills are essential.

Some key qualifications for a job:

We need someone who is very reliable.

We're looking for someone with strong

leadership skills.

We want someone with a good 'track record'.

Absolutely.

In speech, *Absolutely* means I agree/You're right.

... we should advertise with an on-line recruitment agency ...

We can find staff in a *recruitment* or *employment agency*.

How do you recruit staff?

Do you advertise in the local/national newspapers?

British/American differences

British

flexitime

takeaway

American

flextime

takeout

Note: *To be keen on* is only used in British English. It is not used at all in American English.